

Project Management System Notes

Project Management System Notes
Owen Atis Team #14

Wikipedia Source: [Here](#)

- What is a Project Management System:
 - Computer Programs that help plan, organize and manage resources.
- Managing Aspects
 - Estimation and planning
 - Scheduling
 - Sequencing project activities and assigning dates and resources to them.
 - Budget & Resource Management
 - Communication
 - Providing information to various people or stakeholders, used to also measure the level of effort to complete a project.
 - Decision-making
 - Quality Time management
 - Documentation
 - Administration systems.
- Types
 - Collaborative:
 - Used to support multiple users modifying different sections of a plan at once.
 - Examples: Web-based tools like extranets.
 - Limitation: only usable when the user has live internet.
 - Solution: client-server architecture to provide a rich client.
 - Visual:
 - Information visualization such that users can more easily find, analyze and make changes to data.

Adobe Source: [Here](#) - Adobe Workshop

- AI collaborators
 - Agents handle preparation, validation and routine steps so that humans are focused on review, approval and decision-making
 - Centralized AI workforce management: Create, register and manage AI collaborators.
 - Context-driven execution
 - Enterprise-ready intelligence
 - Unified Review and Approval
- Intelligent Planning
 - Accelerate onboarding, planning and executing data with AI
- Connect teams and tools

- Break down silos and manage all work across an organization
- Support multiple work styles such as agile or hybrid approaches.
- Accurately estimating budgeting resource allocation across work initiatives.
- Automate Workflows
 - Streamline execution and accelerate time to market by eliminating manual work, standardizing processes and connecting project workflows.
- Review & Approve
 - Helps teams easily collaborate across applications with automated review and approval capabilities.
 - Deliver more work on time, shorten feedback loops, etc.
- Visibility and Insights
 - Defining clearly how AI is used, maintaining visibility into progress and risk, and ensuring brand, compliance and accountability.

Project Management Systems Rankings: [Here](#)

- Monday.com:
 - Good for: Any Company Size
 - Core Features: Agile Development, Analytics/Reports, API Budget/Expense Tracking, Document Management
 - Integrations: DocuSign, Dropbox, Google Drive, HubSpot, Microsoft Teams
- Smartsheet:
 - Good for: Any Company Size
 - Core Features: Agile Development, Analytics/Reports, API, Billing/Invoicing, Budget/Expense Tracking
 - Integrations: Adobe Creative Cloud, Cisco WebEx, Jira, Microsoft Dynamics 365, Microsoft Teams
- Accelo:
 - Good for: Small, Medium
 - Core Features: Analytics / Reports, API, Billing / Invoicing, Budget / Expense Tracking, Document Management / Sharing
 - Integrations: Authorize.net, Continuum, Expensify, Google Workspace, Gusto
- Forecast:
 - Good for: Small, Medium
 - Core Features: Analytics / Reports, API, Billing / Invoicing, Budget / Expense Tracking, Mobile Capabilities
 - Integrations: Azure DevOps, BambooHR, e-conomic, GitHub, GitLab
- Zoho Projects:
 - Good for: Any Company Size, Micro, Small, Medium, Large
 - Core Features: Agile Development, Analytics / Reports, API, Billing / Invoicing, Budget / Expense Tracking
 - Integrations: BitBucket, GitHub, Google Calendar, Google Docs, Google Drive

Knack Research: [Here](#)

Overview:

1. A digital tool that enables teams to plan, execute, and monitor projects by facilitating task management, collaboration, resource allocation, and progress tracking.
2. Enhances collaboration and communication among team members, improves visibility into project progress, and streamlines task management.
3. Provides a structured approach to project management, leading to improved productivity, better resource utilization, and enhanced decision-making.

Who Uses Project Management Software

- Widely Used across various industries.
- **Construction:**
 - Allows project managers to create timelines, assign tasks to team members, and track progress in real-time.
 - Ensures that construction projects are completed on time and within budget while maintaining communication between subcontractors, suppliers, and clients.
- **Information Technology(IT):**
 - Relies heavily on project software for software development, system implementation, and IT service management.
 - Used to adopt agile methodologies, enabling them to break down projects into manageable tasks, track sprint progress, and facilitate collaboration among developers, testers, and stakeholders.
- **Marketing:**
 - Coordinate campaigns, manage content calendars, and track performance metrics.
 - Help in task assignment, deadline management, and collaboration on creative projects, ensuring that marketing initiatives run smoothly and efficiently.

Types of Project Management Software

1. Task Management Tools
 - a. Focus on organizing assignments, deadlines and daily execution.
 - b. Best for small teams or straightforward projects that need clarity and accountability without extensive oversight.
2. Agile and Scrum Platforms
 - a. Designed for teams using iterative development cycles, supports sprint planning, backlog refinement, and rapid feedback loops.
3. Portfolio and Program Management Tools
 - a. Offer high-level visibility into resource allocation, budgeting, performance trends, and strategic alignment.
 - b. Build for leaders overseeing multiple projects
4. Collaboration-Focused Workspaces

- a. Centralizes communication, file sharing, comments and shared workspaces- especially valuable for distributed or cross-functional teams that need real-time alignment.
- 5. Industry-Specific Project Tools
 - a. Supports niche workflows, such as construction scheduling, engineering approvals, creative production timelines, consulting deliveries, or academic planning.

Pros:

1. Centralized Hub for Project Data & Tasks
 - a. When planning new projects, assigning tasks, or tracking progress against milestones, PMS ensures all relevant data is at your fingertips.
 - b. All updates, feedback, and communications are logged and visible, keeping everyone aligned.
2. Full Visibility Across the Project Lifecycle
 - a. End-to-end project view: track project initiatives from idea to completion in one place.
 - b. See all tasks, assigned owners and each role and milestone in the overall project timeline.
 - c. Keeps everyone informed about their roles and responsibilities and highlights dependencies, ensuring smoother transitions between each project phase.
3. Better Project Forecasting and Risk Analysis
 - a. Automatically triggered alerts when a deadline or budget item is at risk.
4. Improved Project Collaboration and Communication
 - a. PMS act like virtual conference rooms, facilitating seamless communication and communication among teams.
 - b. Integrated ways to discuss ideas, address issues, and document decisions.

Cons:

1. High Software & Implementation Costs
 - a. Hefty price tags associated with acquiring and maintaining a software.
2. Complex Workflows for Simple Tasks Management Needs
 - a. Applicable to smaller or simpler projects, sometimes a PMS may add complexity that isn't needed.
3. Can Involve A Steep Learning Curve
 - a. Sometimes the system needs time for users to adjust.
4. Security and Access Limitations in Traditional Software
 - a. Security Measures and user access controls aren't robust, sensitive data could fall into wrong hands.

Project Management Features to Look For

- Project Templates: pre-designed structures and workflows to various project types.
 - Allow teams to save time and maintain consistency across projects.

- Gantt Charts and Kanban Boards
 - offer visual timelines and workflows to help teams manage tasks and prioritize work efficiently, allowing project managers to track progress, manage deadlines, and identify potential bottlenecks.
- Workflow Automation & Task Management
 - Enhance efficiency and productivity by automating repetitive tasks such as task assignments, notifications and status updates.
- Collaboration Tools
 - Workspaces, real-time messaging, file sharing and collaborative document editing, facilitating seamless communication and teamwork.
- Live Project Tracking & Performance Metrics
 - Up-to-minute insights into project performance and progress.
 - Offer immediate visibility into key performance indicators (KPIs), such as task completion rates, budget utilization, and team productivity.
- Software Integrations for Connected Workflows
 - Allow data to flow seamlessly between applications such as CRM, communication platforms, accounting software, and more, reducing the need for manual data entry and minimizing errors.

Project Management Institute: [Here](#)

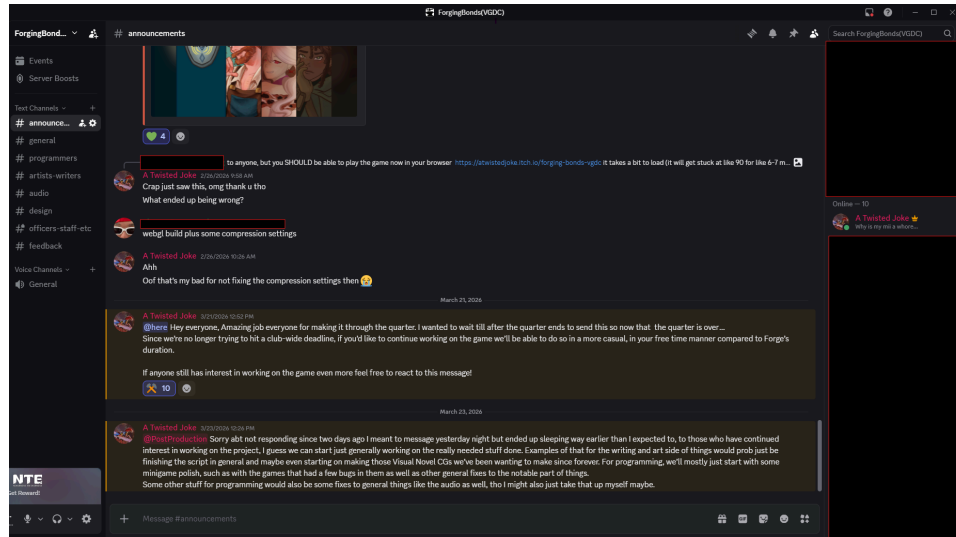
General Considerations for Selecting Software:

- Customization - The ability to modify standard views and Reports
- Import/Export - The ability to use data generated by other packages, or to provide data to other packages in a compatible format.
- Interface - How easily can you navigate through the package.
- Integration w/ third-party products - The compatibility of the package to work with other packages.
- Network capability - The capability to support a local area network environment.
- Performance - The speed and reliability of the package
- Platform - Operation System supported
- Scalability - The ability to run on different types of machines
- Support - The Services provided by the vendor.

Personal PMS Observations

Discord/Slack:

- Near constant communication and event scheduling with servers.
- Easily Able to split a server between a multitude of channels and separate voice chats based on team delegations (tags).

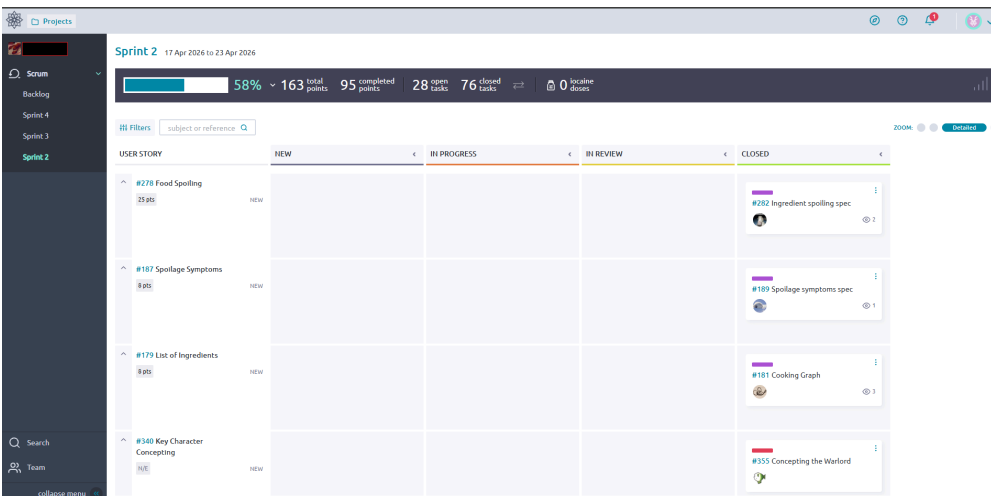
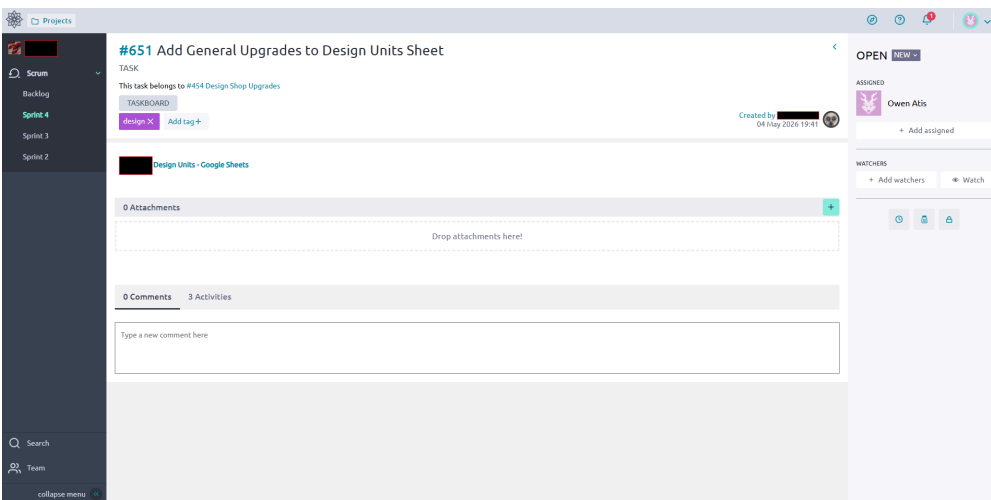
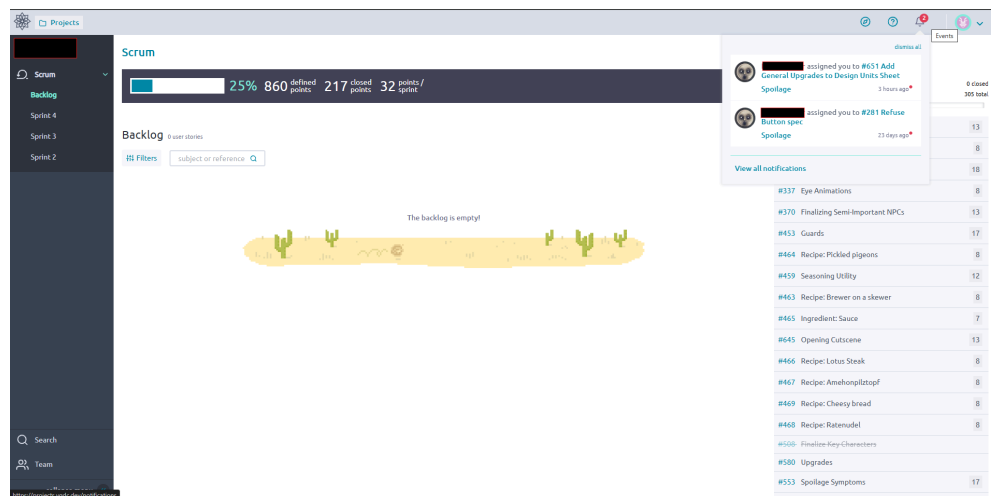


- Visual:
- Lacks:
 - Proper task delegation methods or ways to submit reports on specific tags that aren't just the chats.
 - No Access to a Calendar or Sprint Information included to communicate deadlines or completion progress.

Taiga:

- Very Clearly communicates a backlog and sprint information for any user to navigate through.
 - Each Sprint has a log sheet of what tasks have been made and assigned, their status and value of importance across all teams to contribute on, the completion of a sprint as a percentage, and a communication of the duration of a sprint.
 - Each task clearly communicates their point as a user story or as a simple explanation of what must be done for a user.
 - Backlog allows for previous documentation to be used.
- No actual communication method in taiga, only the details and assigned tasks of a project.

- Visual:



Persona Document & User Story

Persona Document:

Name: John Johnathan Johnson

Details:

25 year old intern with little to no experience in collaborative work. JJJ is scared he may not be doing enough or completing enough of his work compared to the other people in his team but he has no idea how to verify or communicate if that fear is in fact true.

Wants and Needs:

JJJ would like for his and all other tasks and deadlines to be clearly communicated and displayed for him to constantly check and update. That way he can easily tell how much work he was able to complete in a sprint and properly communicate that his part of the work is completed. In a completely personal note as well, he can also verify if his level or work is up to par with his fellow team members, or if he's being kept under the rug compared to most others.

Doesn't Want/Need:

JJJ would like to constantly check on deadlines and his tasks on a regular basis. Because of this, JJJ doesn't really want to have to navigate through multiple segments just to find his tasks. He finds that if he gets lost looking for what is important for him to do he'll end up wasting his time.

User Story

As a software engineer with very tight time availability, I want to be able to easily keep track of my tasks and the sprint deadlines near constantly without any effort, so that I don't waste time navigating through all the tasks in the project just to find out what I am or am not supposed to do.